

hypothesis

DAI

▲ What is it?

Distributed Artificial Intelligence (DAI) is a sub-field of Artificial Intelligence that investigates the behaviour of societies of artificial agents (high level, interacting computer programs). These systems can also be defined as co-operative systems, where a set of agents act together to solve a given problem. These agents are often heterogeneous (for example, in a Decision Support System, the interaction takes place between a human and an artificial problem solver).

▲ What is the technology?

DAI systems are based on different technologies, for instance, distributed expert systems, planning systems or blackboard systems. What is new in the DAI community is the need for methodology for helping in the development and maintenance of DAI systems.

▲ Where do I get more information on it?

www.info.fundp.ac.be/~pys/ModelAge/prop/tableofcontents2_1.html

SNAPSHOT

Online use unaffected
Even after the massive dotcom burst

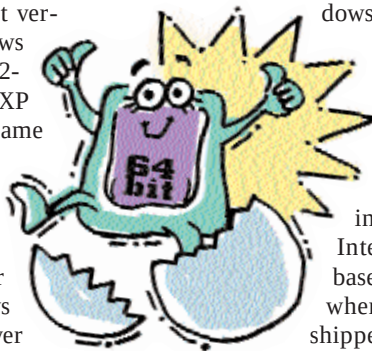
The number of U. S. employees who had their Internet or e-mail usage monitored
14 million

Source: www.cnn.com

A non-beta 64-bit Windows Version

Come October 25, 2001 and Microsoft will be shipping a non-beta 64-bit version of Windows along with the 32-bit Windows XP release on the same day.

The Windows pre-release versions due in October are the Windows Advanced Server Limited Edition version 2002 (pre-release 64-bit



Windows 2002) and the 64-bit version of Windows XP (pre-release 64-bit Windows XP). These 64-bit versions will be installed on Intel's Itanium based systems when they are shipped. Trust Microsoft to know where the money lies!

Linux-powered Palm

Calling all Linux lovers! How about having a Linux compatible OS inside your Palm IIIx or Palm IIIxe? No, this is not a dream.

Empower technologies has come out with Linux DA, an embedded Linux DA O/S v1.0, which will work on Palm IIIx/ IIIxe handhelds. It is basically a Linux compatible OS scaled down for the Motorola Drag-

onball CPU used in Palm handhelds. The OS is designed to completely replace the proprietary Palm OS on the Palm IIIx/ IIIxe models. It claims to have no compatibility problems with the Palm IIIx/ IIIxe hardware. A demo version of Linux DA is available from www.linuxda.com. This version has an address book, scheduler, calculator and games.

Licensing fee for downloads?

That's the road software downloads are going to take if E-Data Systems has its way.

E-Data had patented a system for reproducing information in material objects at a point of sale location back in 1985. Now E-Data wants its share of the pie!

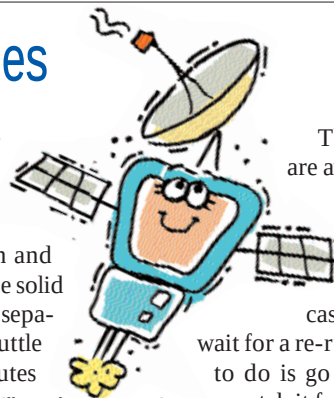
In March 1999, E-Data had lost the case filed against majors like CompuServe and Ziff-Davis publishing in a lower court. The court had ruled that E-Data's patent applies only to data downloaded to systems such as interactive kiosks, CDs, paper, etc and does not apply to software downloads. Now the Federal Circuit U.S Court of Appeals has ordered the court to reconsider the scope of the patent more broadly. This means that all the sites that offer downloads will have to pay E-Data for the download. The site will effectively transfer this fee to the user and thus E-Data will be gaining money for each download we do.

Download satellite launches

If you can watch it on TV, then why not on the Web? Kennedy Space Center's Web site has included downloadable videos of launches starting with the lift off of space shuttle Atlantis on July 12.

Video coverage of the launch will start as soon as the payload doors close, many days before

the launch. The coverage will be available through the final countdown and the launch till the solid rocket boosters separate from the shuttle about two minutes into the flight.



These video clips are available in Real-Media format.

No more problems of missing a tele-

cast or having to wait for a re-run. All you need to do is go to the site and watch it from the archives.

Illustrations: Farzana Cooper